Call for Abstracts

SETAC North America 47th Annual Meeting

November 2-5, 2026 - Montréal, Québec, Canada

Session title

Beyond the Usual Suspects: Exploring Emerging PFAS in Uncommon Systems

Session description

Few chemicals have gained as much global notoriety in recent years as per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS), a class that includes over 14,000 chemicals with diverse structures and physicochemical properties. PFAS are anthropogenic chemicals that have been detected in people, wildlife, and the environment worldwide, even in regions where no PFAS production or release is expected. In humans, exposure to certain PFAS has been linked to adverse health effects like increased cholesterol, decreased vaccine response, and cancer. PFAS are remarkably resistant to degradation, meaning these “forever chemicals” will concern researchers and communities for years to come. Measuring PFAS in biological tissue and exposure media is critical for evaluating bioaccumulation potential, informing risk assessments, and understanding the scope of global PFAS contamination. Despite the large body of information available on PFAS, several key information gaps still exist. Measurements commonly focus on a limited number of PFAS from specific structural subclasses with emerging compounds being relatively data-poor. Biological PFAS research has primarily focused on humans, birds, fish, and freshwater ecosystems, while exposure research has centered around the ingestion of contaminated drinking water and food. PFAS bioaccumulation trends and exposure pathways can vary regionally; however, most PFAS studies have been done in the northern hemisphere and high-income countries. In this session, attendees will learn about emerging PFAS in currently under-studied and under-represented areas. Presenters will call attention to critical PFAS research occurring in uncommon spaces, bringing awareness to a broader audience to help build inclusive solutions to the PFAS problem. Presentations are encouraged that focus on novel sampling procedures for interesting biota, advanced analytical methods for measuring emerging PFAS in challenging matrices or exposure systems, experiments centered in the southern hemisphere or low-income regions, or other unusual PFAS exposure assessments. This session is open to researchers from various sectors (government, academia, industry) and applications involving chemical analyses of PFAS, especially emerging PFAS, in systems that are not currently well-represented in literature.

We welcome contributions on

- Novel or adapted sampling procedures for PFAS in difficult matrices
- Development and application of advanced analytical methods (e.g., total fluorine, extractable organic fluorine, non-targeted analysis) for PFAS characterization
- Investigations of PFAS in understudied populations, matrices, or regions

Presentation types

- Both oral presentations and posters are welcome.

Key dates

- **Abstract submission deadline (free):** June 3, 2026
- **Abstract submission deadline ($50 fee):** June 10, 2026
- **Meeting registration deadline:** October 14, 2026
- **Annual Meeting:** November 2–5, 2026 — Montréal, Québec

Session chairs

- **Anna Boatman,** ULRI
- **Sydney Brady,** Agilent Technologies
- **Alyssa Wicks,** Duke University
- **Heather Whitehead**, ULRI

How to submit

- Submit your abstract at: **setac.org/montreal**
- Select “Track 4: Chemistry and Exposure Assessment - Beyond the Usual Suspects: Exploring Emerging PFAS in Uncommon Systems”
- For questions, contact: anna.boatman@ul.org ; **north-america-meeting@setac.org**